Electric shaRed mOBility hUbs Trial (ROBUST): Co-design Workshop 1, Letterkenny

James Reynolds and Brian McCann (ATU)

Wednesday 15th April, 2026

Railway stations and other transport nodes often do more than just move people and goods - they might also be places with shopping, food, other services and facilities, and provide a '3rd space' for community interaction. Along similar lines, recent research has emphasised the important of the 'Place' function for roads, alongside the more traditional focus in traffic engineering on the demensions of movement and access to adjoining land uses.[1]

Shared electric mobility hubs are new form of transport node that might support more sustainable travel choices, especially in contexts such as regional towns where providing high frequency transit services is challenging. These may help provide transition pathways towards lower carbon-emitting transport systems without some of the problems associated with other forms of shared and micro-mobility (e.g. charging fire risks, inappropriate parking of dockless bikes and scooters).[2] Such hubs may also allow households to shift towards more walking, cycling and transit use, including through facilitating those occasional trips that might otherwise be challenging (e.g. beyond walking/cycling distance, outside typical service times, carrying luggage).

Four shared e-mobility hubs have been implemented in Letterkenny, Galway, Waterford and Dundrum, with each including e-bikes, an e-cargo bike and shared electric cars as an inital offering, plus *power supply infrastructure* to support current on-site recharging and other *future uses*. These represent a considerable capital investment in mobility infrastructure and potential opportunities for further development. However, it is unclear how community use of these hubs might best be supported so as to improve transport sustainability, or how the hubs and surrounds might better meet local needs[3].

The ROBUST research project seeks better understanding of: the encouragement, educational and other 'non-(major)-infrastructure' interventions[4] that might support community use of hubs; how to expand the mobility offer; and to build partnerships with community and other stakeholders so as to maximise impacts of each hub's implementation. To this end, ATU is hosting Co-design Workshops with key stakeholders to gain bottom-up insights from practitioners, prior to further engagement. This note provides details of the agenda for the first Co-design Workshop, to be held in Letterkenny on the

ROBUST

[1] Alexa Delbosc et al., "American Complete Streets and Australian SmartRoads: What Can We Learn from Each Other?" *Transportation Research Record*, 2018.

Figure 1: E-bikes @ the Letterkenny hub

[2] Ze Zhang, Yuchen Guo, and Li Feng, "Externalities of Dockless Bicycle-Sharing Systems: Implications for Green Recovery of the Transportation Sector," *Economic Analysis and Policy* 76 (2022): 410–19; Beth Ferguson and Jordan Scott Blandino, "Shared Micromobility Vehicle Design and Safety," 2025.

[3] Perhaps the hub can support existing local programs and activities (e.g. vehicle use by meals-on-wheels, sporting clubs, for library programs or by council staff to support service delivery)? Or they might allow for pop-ups or additional facilities (e.g. café, luggage storage, delivery services) that increase activity and therefore improve safety and security (i.e. through Jane Jacob's "eyes on the street").

[4] John Williams, Andy Clarke, and Kathleen McLaughlin, *Balancing Engineering, Education, Law Enforcement, and Encouragement* (Washington, DC, USA: National Bicycling; Walking Study, US Department of Transport, Federal Highway Administration, 1993).

morning of Wednesday 1st April, 2026[5].

10am: meet at hub

The Letterkenny hub is at the Justice Walsh Road carpark. We will meet there, inspect the site and then use the hub's vehicles to reach ATU for morning coffee/tea.

[5] Objectives include: 1. Stakeholder engagement, and an opportunity for practitioners to try the hub out for themselves! 2. Increase coordination of efforts going forward; 3. Initial steps towards further co-design workshops, potentially involving community stakeholders, and increasing the mobility hub offer.

Figure 2: Buildings and streetnetwork near Letterkenny hub, by walking distance (m)

11:30am: co-design workshop followed by lunch

The UK Design Council[6] Double Diamond design process suggests alternate converging and diverging steps of: Discovery; Definition, Development and Delivery. The co-design workshop will spend roughly 30 minutes on each step, tackling issues such as: signage and linemarking; minor works and placemaking; community, business and council engagement and events; and others as discovered.

[6] "The Double Diamond," undated, `https://www.designcouncil.org.uk/our-resources/the-double-diamond/`.

Figure 3: Double Diamond process

2pm: return vehicles and close

- Facilitators: James Reynolds[7] and Brian McCann[8].
- Eight spaces available due to vehicle capacity limitations:
  1. Clodagh Campbell (Donegal Active Travel)
  2. Michael Canning (Donegal Active Travel);
  3. Lorraine Arbuckle (Climate Action Officer);
  4. Bryan Cannon (Donegal Council)
  5. Saqib Jamil (Donegal Council);
  6. Margaret Toner (Letterkenny Community Development Project);
  7. Mary Clyde (PPN Resource Worker);
  8. Martin McBride (North Donegal Community Network).
- Outputs of the co-design workshop (plans, notes etc.) may form inputs to future academic publications, but individual participants will not be identified.
- Please bring a safety vest, sturdy shoes, a bicycle helmet and rain coat.

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